Falling tone is the most common type of intonation in English. It is used for asking and giving information in a normal, quiet, style. Usually statements, that are categorical, confident and convincing, are expressed in this tone.

Standard patterns:

Falling tone is used on the last stressed syllable of the sentence in

Statements(declarative sentences):

We live in \Chennai.
He doesn't have the \book.

Questions:

What do you\want?

Commands (imperative sentences):

Close the \door.

Come \here.

Exclamatory sentences:

What a pleasant sur\prise!
Amazing \shot!

The last part of alternative questions (after "or")

Would you like to have coffee or \ tea?

Do you want a pen or a pen\cil?

Tag questions(When the answer is sure to be 'yes')

You live here, don't \you?

Rising intonation in English expresses a number of emotions such as : non-finality, surprise, doubt, politeness, interest, lack of confidence etc. Standard rising intonation in English usually goes down a little first and then rises up.

Rising intonation is used in

Statement intended to be a question

You came here to/day? (I thought you came last night.)
He left so /early? (I thought he would wait.)

Statement intended to be reassuring

I will come with /you. (So don't worry.)
I hope you will be /ok (So don't worry.)

Question expressing curiosity to know

What are you do/ing?

When is the next /train?

Yes/No Questions (Polar Questions)

Can you /show it?
Have you fi/nished?

Exclamations intended to be a question

Re/ally? (I never thought so.)

/What? (unbelievable)

Greetings and Wishes

Good /Morning!

He/llo!

Happy New Year!

Rhetorical Question

Who knows what will /happen?

Can Spring be far be/hind?

Apostrophes / Direct address

The child is father of the /man!

Sir, you dropped your/ phone.

12th Communicative English Book.indb 79 02/02/19 5:09 PM